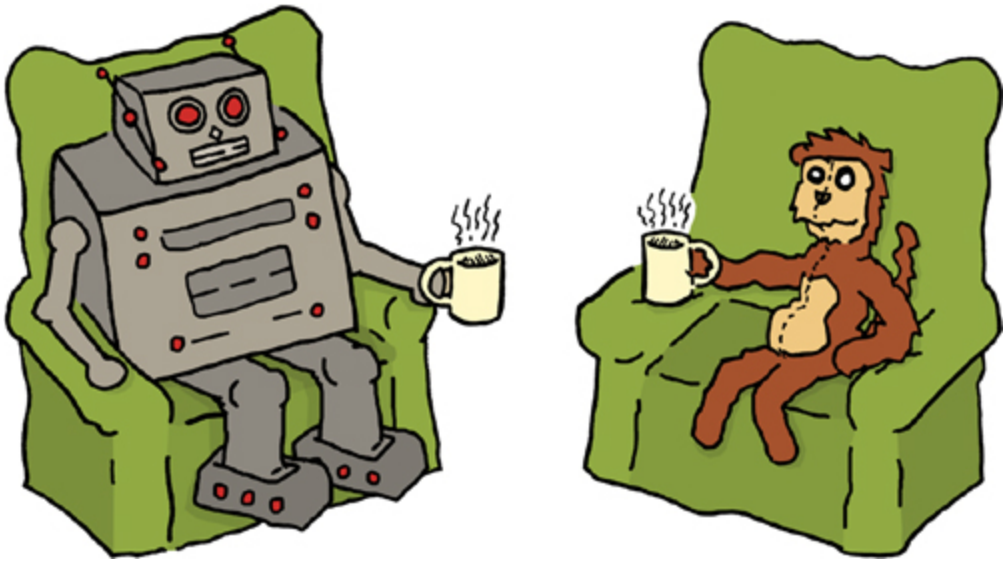
to peel back those layers. Think of your JavaScript programs as being CoffeeScript programs underneath.

Why CoffeeScript? One reason is that it can help you to make smaller and easier-to-understand programs that are easier to maintain. You say you don't have a problem with programs being large, difficult to understand, and difficult to maintain? Meet Agtron and Scruffy (figure 1.1).

Figure 1.1. Meet Agtron and Scruffy.



Agtron and Scruffy have recently started working on a massive JavaScript program. This program contains more lines of JavaScript than Scruffy cares to count (though Agtron informs Scruffy that when he last looked it was 532,565). Agtron and Scruffy both consider the application they inherited to be disgusting. Scruffy thinks it's disgusting because he can't figure out what's going on. Agtron thinks it's disgusting because he *can* figure out what's going on. Why is the program disgusting? Because it's too big and the different components are too complicated and intertwined. The program is incomprehensible. Understanding how any of it works requires understanding of how *all* of it works.

How might CoffeeScript help? By simplifying JavaScript syntax and making each line easier to comprehend. That simplicity of expression will encourage you to compose programs that are, in turn, simpler and easier to